

Table 12.3 : Myers' Index by District and Sex, 2012, 2024

District	2012			2024			Percentage Change
	Both sexes	Male	Female	Both sexes	Male	Female	
Sri Lanka	1.7	1.8	1.7	1.2	1.2	1.1	-29.4
Colombo	2.2	2.5	2.0	1.6	1.9	1.5	-27.3
Gampaha	2.2	2.3	2.2	1.3	1.3	1.4	-40.9
Kalutara	2.2	2.2	2.2	1.1	1.1	1.1	-50.0
Kandy	1.6	1.6	1.5	1.3	1.2	1.3	-18.8
Matale	1.8	1.7	2.0	1.4	1.5	1.4	-22.2
Nuwara Eliya	0.9	1.6	0.8	1.1	1.6	1.0	22.2
Galle	1.6	1.8	1.6	0.9	1.0	1.0	-43.8
Matara	1.4	1.3	1.6	1.1	1.0	1.1	-21.4
Hambantota	2.3	2.4	2.2	1.4	1.6	1.3	-39.1
Jaffna	2.3	2.1	2.4	2.9	2.8	2.9	26.1
Mannar	1.3	1.9	1.6	1.3	2.1	1.0	0.0
Vavuniya	2.8	2.6	3.0	2.7	2.9	3.0	-3.6
Mullaitivu	2.8	2.0	4.0	2.5	2.4	2.6	-10.7
Kilinochchi	2.5	2.9	2.3	2.4	2.7	2.5	-4.0
Batticaloa	1.4	1.2	1.5	1.8	2.1	1.9	28.6
Ampara	1.5	1.5	1.6	1.2	1.2	1.6	-20.0
Trincomalee	2.4	2.6	2.3	1.6	2.0	1.3	-33.3
Kurunegala	2.2	2.1	2.4	1.3	1.3	1.5	-40.9
Puttalam	1.7	1.7	1.9	1.1	1.0	1.2	-35.3
Anuradhapura	2.3	2.1	2.6	2.0	1.9	2.1	-13.0
Polonnaruwa	2.2	2.4	2.3	1.6	1.8	1.7	-27.3
Badulla	1.3	1.2	1.4	1.3	1.3	1.3	0.0
Moneragala	1.3	1.1	1.5	0.9	0.8	1.1	-30.8
Ratnapura	2.0	2.0	2.0	1.5	1.5	1.5	-25.0
Kegalle	2.2	2.1	2.3	1.4	1.5	1.4	-36.4

Table 12.3 presents the values of Myers' Index calculated by district and sex for the 2012 and 2024 Censuses of Population and Housing. The value of Myers' Index for Sri Lanka declined from 1.7 in 2012 to 1.2 in 2024, representing a 29.4 percent reduction. This indicates that the accuracy of age reporting in the 2024 Census has improved compared to the 2012 Census.

At the district level, most districts show a decline in the Myers' Index value. Notably, substantial reductions are observed in Kalutara (-50.0%), Galle (-43.8%), Gampaha (-40.9%), and Kurunegala (-40.9%), suggesting improved accuracy in age reporting in these districts. However, a slight increase in the index value is observed in Batticaloa (28.6%), Jaffna (26.1%) and Nuwara Eliya (22.2%), which may indicate minor deviations in age reporting in those districts. Overall, the results suggest that the age data collected in the Census of Population and Housing - 2024 are of high accuracy, as reflected by the low values of Myers' Index.